

Miners Lose No. 1 Shortstop

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

The University of Texas at El Paso baseball team has yet to begin the 1976 season and already Coach Andy Cohen is faced with a major obstacle.

It was learned Monday morning that starting shortstop Dave Nance will be ineligible for the upcoming season. "It was something I wasn't expecting," said Cohen after finding out that Nance had already used up his 10 semesters allowed under NCAA rules. "It'll really hurt the team."

Without Nance at short to shore up the infield, the Miners have been forced to turn their attention toward unproven Dave Patt, a part-timer last season.

"I'm not entirely a newcomer at the position," said Patt. "It'll take some time for me to get in the groove."

Time is not exactly what the Miners have. Friday and Saturday, UTEP hosts Ranger Junior College in back-to-back doubleheaders beginning at 1 p.m. both days at the Ysleta Cutoff.

Cohen's tentative starting lineup has sophomore Art Bravo, a graduate of Austin High School, leading off and playing second. Newcomer

Dave Nance



David Carrillo from Van Horn will be playing center and batting second.

Then comes the meat of the lineup with Hills Junior College transfer Keith Dwinell at first and Glenn Villarreal, this year's captain, in the cleanup position and playing third base.

Outfielders Terry Dillingham and Keith Rushing follow in the batting order before designated hitter Steve Dau and freshman catcher Terry Goodro take their turns at bat. Patt will be ninth in the lineup and Jeff Hogan is slated to hurl the opener against Ranger.

"I think we've got one of the best groups of outfielders we've ever had out here," said Cohen as he looked over the 40-plus athletes trying out for the 27-28 man team.

"Besides the kids I have starting, there are people like

Mark Grissom from Coronado and Chris Forbes of Austin who are real good," said Cohen. "Sal Flores of El Paso High is another good outfielder.

"Any other year, these kids would be starters for me but there's such good competition this year that it'll be hard to pick the starting three."

As for the upcoming season, which officially begins March 5 against Abilene Christian College, team captain Villarreal foresees a "somewhat better team than from last season. Right now, we're a little more ahead of ourselves and the attitude seems to be much better," he said.

"I think we're going to peak and stay there longer than last year because a lot of the guys are interested in baseball this year. You can see it when they stay after workouts to try to better themselves."

Cohen expects his pitching staff to consist primarily of Hogan, Mike Rima, Andy Grooms, Dau, Gary Kobat,

Jerry Walker and Joe Dehn. Western Athletic Conference play begins April 9 against New Mexico.

1976 Miner Baseball Schedule		
Date	Opponent	Time
Feb. 20	Ranger Junior College (DH) YC	1 p.m.
Feb. 21	Ranger Junior College (DH) YC	1 p.m.
March 5	Abilene Christian Col. (DH) YC	1 p.m.
March 6	Abilene Christian College YC	1 p.m.
March 13	Denver University (DH) YC	1 p.m.
March 15	New Mexico State (DH) YC	1 p.m.
March 17	Denver University YC	1 p.m.
March 20	New Mexico Highlands (DH) YC	1 p.m.
March 23	Colorado State U. (DH) D	1 p.m.
March 24	at New Mexico State (DH)	
April 9	*New Mexico D	1 p.m.
April 10	*New Mexico (DH) D	12 p.m.
April 12	El Paso Diablos (Exhibition) D	7 p.m.
April 16	*at Arizona	
April 17	*at Arizona (DH)	
April 20	Adams State (DH) D	1 p.m.
April 23	*at Arizona State	
April 24	*at Arizona State (DH)	
April 30	*Arizona D	12 p.m.
May 1	*Arizona (DH) D	11 p.m.
May 7	*Arizona State D	12 p.m.
May 8	*Arizona State (DH) D	11 p.m.
May 14	*at New Mexico	
May 15	*at New Mexico (DH)	

Home Games — YC — Ysleta Cutoff Field; D — Dudley Field

* — Western Athletic Conference Southern Division Games

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